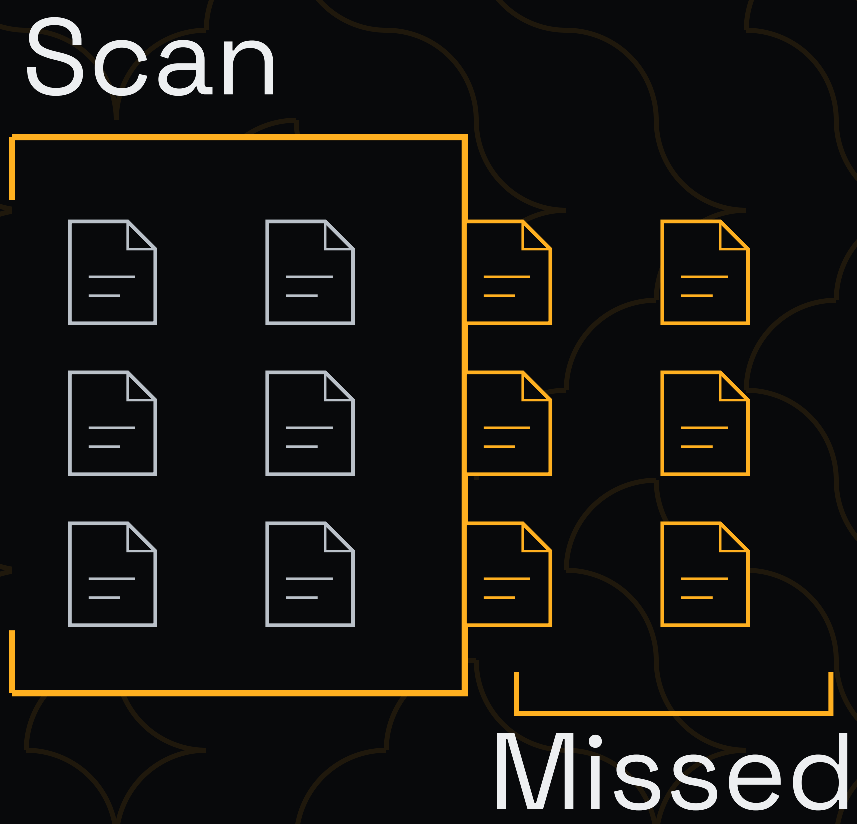
A pass with nothing behind it.

I had a check missing files it was supposed to inspect.



The scan boundary was incomplete.

Rerunning can give the same reassurance.

The output looked clean. Part of the material had never reached the check.

An incomplete search can return a pass.

There are two questions inside that green result.

I want an answer to each before I rely on it.

01 Did this run reach the intended material?

02 Can the detector still recognise a known defect?

Coverage and detection are separate.

Start with what the run actually read.

Inspect the selected files and exclusions. Compare them with an independently stated scope.

01 Name what should be in scope.

02 Inspect what was selected.

03 Explain what was left out.

A plausible count alone is not enough.

Give the detector a reason to object.

Use a controlled fixture containing a known defect. Check that the detector rejects it.

Known bad input
→ expected rejection

Suggested detector test.

The canary can pass while the real run misses files.

A self-test exercises its own inputs. It does not establish that the normal selection reaches every intended file.

01 Test the detector on the fixture.

02 Test the real selection separately.

Keep both observations visible.

Try excluding something that should be included.

I would deliberately remove an in-scope file from a controlled selection, then check whether the coverage guard notices.

Missing coverage should stay visible.

Suggested coverage test; no new result claimed.

Let the pass say what it has earned.

State what was inspected and which defect the detector could catch. That gives the next person a boundary they can judge.

Neither check proves the whole system correct.